2. THE ALLEGED CONSPIRACY

Around 2020, Adani Green Energy and Azure Power **allegedly conspire to bribe officials** of Indian power discoms to push them into signing PSAs with SECI



Gautam Adani
Chairman, Adani Group



Sagar Adani
Adani's nephew



Vneet S. Jaain
CEO, Adani Green Energy



Ranjit Gupta
Then CEO, Azure Power

Subsequently, **four others join the conspiracy**. CDPQ, a Canadian pension fund, is the majority shareholder in Azure



Cyril Cabanes
Sr Executive, CDPQ



Saurabh Agarwal
Cabanes's subordinate



Deepak Malhotra
CDPQ employee, India



Rupesh Agarwal
CEO, Azure Power from Aug. 2022

In 2021, Adani executives reportedly meet government officials in Andhra Pradesh, Jammu & Kashmir, Tamil Nadu and Chhattisgarh, allegedly planning bribes amounting to **$265 mn** (Rs 2,236 cr.); **$228 mn** (Rs 1,926 cr.) was for Andhra alone

Between Jul. 2021 and Feb. 2022, discoms in Odisha, Jammu & Kashmir, Tamil Nadu, Chhattisgarh and Andhra Pradesh **sign PSAs with SECI**

Between Oct. 2021 and Feb. 2022, **Azure Power and Adani Green Energy finalise PPAs with SECI.** Prosecutors allege the deal involved investments of **$6 bn** (Rs 50,682 cr.) in all, with expected profit after taxes of **$2 bn** (Rs 16,894 cr.) over 20 years

3. THE INVESTIGATION

In 2020, the US Justice Department, Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) and the Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI) **begin investigation** into the deal

Of the alleged bribe of $265 mn for the deal, Azure's share is determined at $7 mn (Rs 59 cr.) for 650 MW PPAs and $76 mn (Rs 642 cr.) for 2.3 GW PPAs. **Gautam allegedly proposed Azure transfer its 2.3 GW PPAs to Adani Green Energy instead of paying cash.** Sagar and Vneet then allegedly influenced SECI to reallocate these PPAs to Adani

In Mar. 2022, SEC begins inquiring into Azure's contracts. **Azure decides to reveal certain information** about Adani's requests for bribe money but conceals its own involvement

Meanwhile, between 2020 and 2024, **Adani Green Energy raises over $2 bn in loans from international financial institutions** and US-based asset management companies (AMCs), alongside **$1 bn in securities** sold to US investors. Prosecutors say they denied any malpractice

Cabanes, Saurabh, Deepak and Rupesh **allegedly conceal the bribery scheme from US authorities** and obstruct investigations by a grand jury in New York, the FBI and the SEC

In Mar. 2023, the FBI seizes Sagar Adani's electronic devices in the US. **He allegedly monitored bribes to states and corresponding solar power contracts**

Graphic by **TANMOY CHAKRABORTY**